Which of the statements given above are correct?
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans : (a) The East India Company's monopoly of trade in India was abolished by the Charter Act of 1813, although it was granted a waiver of monopoly on trade with China and the trade of tea. The constitutional position of the British in India was clarified for the first time by this act. This strengthened the sovereignty of the British crown over the Indian territories occupied by the company. The superintendence and controlling power of the Board of Control were not only defined but also expanded by the charter of 1813. The East India Company was given the right to control the Indian territories and the revenue for the next 20 years. Whereas the revenue of India was brought under the control of the British parliament by the Act of 1853 and not by the Charter Act of 1813. Hence, statement 3 is wrong.

15. Consider the following pairs :
Movement/organization Leader
(a) All India Anti Untouchability league: Mahatma Gandhi
(b) All India Kisan Sabha: Swami Sahajanand Saraswati
(c) Self-Respect Movement : E. V. Ramaswami Naicker
Which of the Pairs given above is/are correctly matched?
(a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans : (d)

Movements/ organization	Leader	Establishment Year
All India Anti Untouchability League	Mahatma Gandhi	1932
All India Kisan Sabha	Swami Sahajanand Saraswati	1936
Self-respect Movement	E.V. Ramaswami Naicker	1920

• Freedom Struggle & National Movement

16. With reference to Swadeshi Movement, consider the following statements :
1. It contributed to the revival of the indigenous artisan crafts and industries.
2. The National Council of Education was established as a part of Swadeshi Movement.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans : (c) The Swadeshi Movement received a lot of strength from the Bang-Bhang movement in the year 1905. It lasted until 1911 and was one of the most successful movements before Gandhiji made his debut in India. Under this movement, not only was the boycott of foreign clothes but it was decided to boycott all foreign goods. The major achievement of this movement was self-reliance and self-power. This movement played an important role in reviving the skills and industries of the indigenous craftsmen and in upgrading and promoting them. The National Council of Education was established on 15 August, 1906 as an element of the Swadeshi Movement.

GEOGRAPHY OF INDIA

• Physical Structure / Drainage System / Human Geography / Tribes

17. Consider the following statements about Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups (PVTGs) in India :
1. PVTGs reside in 18 States and one Union Territory.
2. A stagnant or declining population is one of the criteria for determining PVTG status.
3. There are 95 PVTGs officially notified in the country so far.
4. Irular and Konda Reddi tribes are included in the list of PVTGs.
Which of the statements given above are correct?
(a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 2, 3 and 4
(c) 1, 2 and 4 (d) 1, 3 and 4

Ans : (c) The 75 tribal groups have been classified as Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups (PVTGs) by the Ministry of Home Affairs, Government of India. PVTGs are inhabited in the 17 states and one union territory of Andaman and Nicobar Islands (census 2011). The Ministry of Tribal Affairs implements the plan for the development of vulnerable Tribal Groups (PVTGs).
The Irular (Tamil Nadu) and Konda Reddi tribes, which inhabit both on the banks of the Godavari river in Andhra Pradesh and Tamil Nadu and the hilly areas and forests of the East and West Godavari and Khamman districts, are included in the list of PVTGs.

18. Consider the following pairs :

Glacier		River
1. Bandarpunch	:	**Yamuna**
2. Bara Shigri	:	**Chenab**
3. Milam	:	**Mandakini**
4. Siachen	:	**Nubra**
5. Zemu	:	**Manas**

Which of the pairs given above are correctly matched?
(a) 1,2 and 4 (b) 1, 3 and 4
(c) 2 and 5 (d) 3 and 5

Ans : (a) In the given pairs 1, 2 and 4 are correctly matched while pairs 3 and 5 are incorrectly matched, because the origin of the Mandakini river is in the Chorabari Glacier near Kedarnath (Uttarakhand) and Zemu glacier is the origin of river Teesta.
So, the correct matches are–

Glacier	River
Bandarpunch	Yamuna
Bara Shigri	Chenab
Milam	Gori Ganga
Siachen	Nubra
Zemu	Teesta

19. Consider the following pairs :

Famous place	River
(1) Pandharpur	**Chandrabhaga**
(2) Tiruchirapalli	**Cauvery**
(3) Hampi	**Malaprabha**

which of the pairs given above are correctly matched?
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans : (a)

Famous places	River
1. Pandharpur	Chandrabhaga (Maharashtra)
2. Tiruchirappalli	Cauvery (Tamil Nadu)
3. Hampi	Tungabhadra (Karnataka)

So, the correct matches from the following pairs are 1 and 2 only.

• Monsoon, Forest, Soil, Irrigation Projects and Agriculture

20. What is common to the places known as Alyar, Isapur and Kangsabati?
(a) Recently discovered uranium deposits
(b) Tropical rain forests
(c) Underground cave systems
(d) Water reservoirs

Ans : (d) Aliyar dam is located in Tamil Nadu. This dam was built during 1959 to 1969. This dam was constructed under the Aliyar project. Parambikulam-Aliyar project is a joint project of Kerala and Tamil Nadu.
Isapur Dam is one of the major dams in Maharashtra, which is built on the Penganga river. The Penganga river divides Maharashtra in two regions of Vidarbha and Marathwada.
The Kangsabati project was started in 1956 in West Bengal as part of India's second Five-year plan to provide 3,484,77 square kilometers of groundwater in Midnapore, Bankura and Hooghly districts.

21. Consider the following States :
1. Chhattisgarh 2. Madhya Pradesh
3. Maharashtra 4. Odisha
With reference to the States mentioned above, in terms of percentage of forest cover to the total area of State, which one of the following is the correct ascending order?
(a) 2–3–1–4 (b) 2–3–4–1
(c) 3–2–4–1 (d) 3–2–1–4

Ans : (c) According to Indian state of Forest Report 2019 published by the Forest Survey of India (FSI), area wise Madhya Pradesh has the largest forest cover in the country followed by Arunachal Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Odisha and Maharashtra. So the correct order is-
3 < 4 < 1 < 2.

22. Which one of the following groups of plants was domesticated in the 'New world' and introduced into the 'Old world'?
(a) Tobacco, cocoa and rubber
(b) Tobacco, cotton and rubber
(c) Cotton, Coffee and sugarcane
(d) Rubber, coffee and wheat

Ans : (a) The New World (Americas Region) and the old world refer to Africa, Asia and Europe. Plants that were practiced in the ancient world like sunflower, pineapple, papaya, potato, tomato, tobacco, rubber, cocoa, cotton, etc. In these plants mainly tobacco, cocoa, rubber were made arable in the new world. However, apart from these cotton, maize, etc were also practised from the ancient world, but they could not be made arable on a large scale in the new world.

23. Consider the following statements :
(1) As per law, the Compensatory Afforestation Fund Management and Planning Authority exists at both National and State Levels.
(2) People's participation is mandatory in the compensatory afforestation programmes carried out under the Compensatory Afforestation Fund Act. 2016
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans : (a) The compensatory Afforestation Fund Act, 2016 came into force in the county in the year 2016. The act provides for the setting up of compensatory Afforestation fund Management and planning authority (CAMPA) a both the central and state levels to ensure prompt and transparent use of the amounts received in lieu of the given land for non-forest purposes.
There is no provision for participation of the people in the compensatory Afforestation programs run under the compensatory fund act, 2016.

• Minerals, Power Resources, Industries & Trade

24. With reference to the management of minor minerals in India, consider the following statements :
1. Sand is a 'minor mineral' according to the prevailing law in the country.
2. State Governments have the power to grant mining leases of minor minerals, but the powers regarding the formation of rules related to the grant of minor minerals lie with the Central Government.
3. State Governments have the power to frame rules to prevent illegal mining of minor minerals.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?